THE ARTEMIS PROGRAMME

Conceived as a stepping stone for Mars, Artemis is a series of NASA missions aimed at landing astronauts on the Moon and ultimately building a lunar space station called Gateway

ARTEMIS I

Unmanned mission to test NASA's most powerful rocket to date, the **Space Launch System** (SLS), and Orion spacecraft

MISSION DURATION
25 days

LAUNCH: Nov. 16, 2022

SPLASHDOWN
Dec. 11, 2022

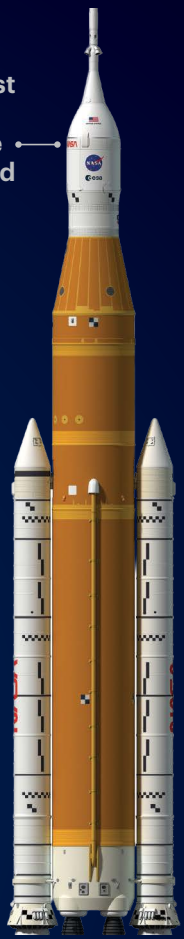
ARTEMIS II

Crewed fly-by mission to test the systems necessary to support astronauts in deep space exploration and safely return them to Earth

MISSION DURATION
10 days

LAUNCH: 2026*

**Planned March launch deferred, pending repairs*



ARTEMIS III

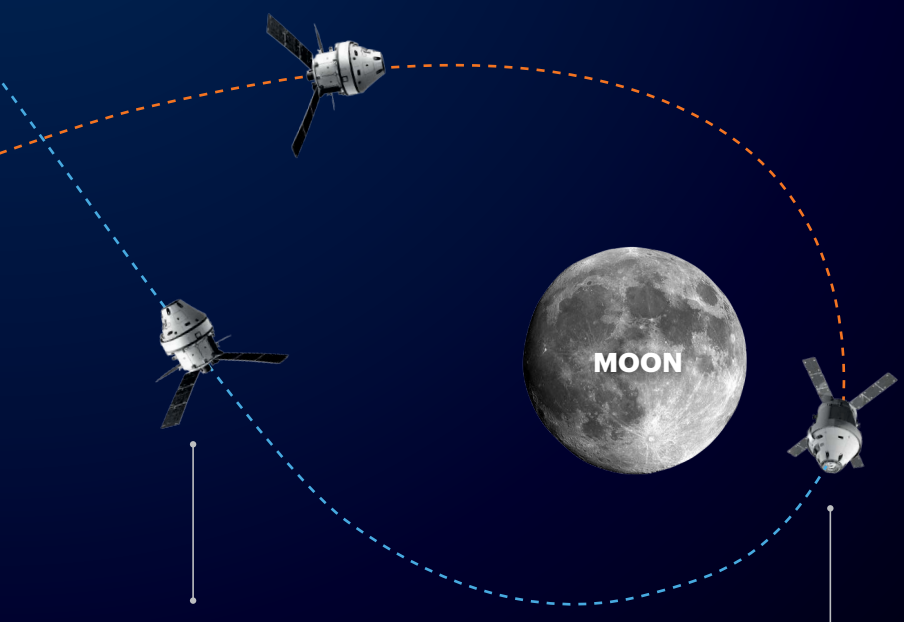
Originally meant to land two astronauts on the Moon by 2028 to explore the lunar South Pole region, NASA is in the process of redefining this mission. Now, advanced to 2027, it will test systems and operations, including the rendezvous and docking with the moon landers, in low-earth orbit

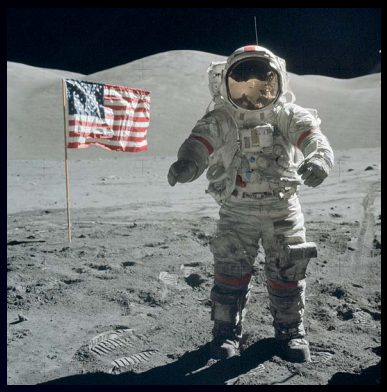
LAUNCH: 2027

ARTEMIS IV

Now, this will be the first crewed Moon landing mission, and thereon NASA aims to undertake "at least one surface landing every year"

LAUNCH: 2028





Between 1968 and 1972, 24 astronauts travelled to the Moon on NASA's Apollo missions; 12 walked on its surface—the last was Eugene Cernan in December 1972

THE OTHER MOONSHOTS

CHINA

CREWED MOON LANDING TARGETED BY 2030

- With six Chang'e missions (2007–2024), China moved from orbiting the Moon to landing a rover on its uncharted far side and bringing back samples
- In August 2025, it tested the Lanyue lander, which will be used in the crewed landing
- In February 2026, it test-flew the Long March-10 rocket being developed for it

INDIA

CREWED MOON LANDING TARGETED BY 2040

- Through Chandrayaan-3 (2023), India demonstrated lunar soft-landing capability
- The SpaDeX docking experiment (2025) was a key step toward crewed missions
- Gaganyaan aims to send three Indian astronauts on orbital spaceflight by 2027
- Chandrayaan-4, with a likely launch by 2028, aims to bring back lunar samples. Chandrayaan-5 will study the Moon's potential to host humans, followed by more missions to build capabilities for the eventual crewed landing